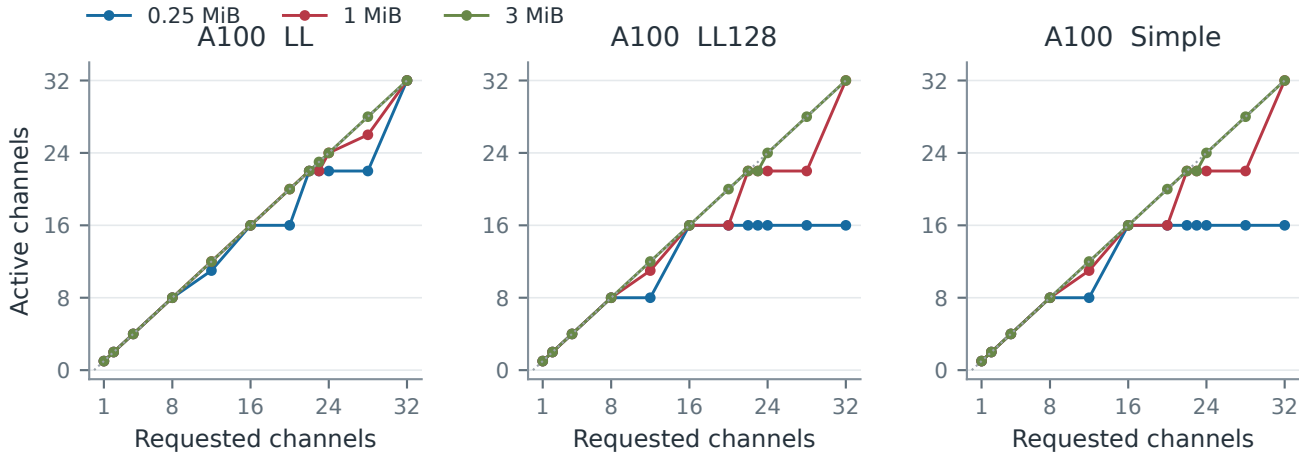


A channel request is a budget, not the executed channel count

Separate selection observers; four GPUs; no timing values used



NCCL partitions the payload into work cells. Fewer active channels invalidate a fixed-request causal contrast.